Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**Design Technology**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	Can compostable materials be a sustainable solution to how the fields of mass manufactured EPS food packaging contributed to the world's environmental causes?		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**2**	Research question: Markband 1-2 The research question (RQ) is relevant to the topic, clear but only partially focused in relation to the scope of the essay. The main evidence is the selection of compostable materials for food packaging. Final mark awarded for the descriptor: 2 Research methods: Markband 1-2 Some of the research methods are used, others are simply mentioned without pieces of evidence throughout the extended essay (EE). Final mark awarded for the descriptor: 2 Structure: Markband 1-2 The structural conventions for this type of Design Technology (DT) EE are present but superficial. There is a clear lack of final proofreading, formal errors in basic aspects (e.g. blank spaces, bibliography, blank sections). Final mark for the descriptor: 2	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**2**	Knowledge: Markband 1-2 Research materials are used trying, to give a proper answer to the RQ (mainly secondary ones) but lacking efficiency when used. Final mark for descriptor: 2 Understanding-Terminology: Markband 3-4 Some relevant terminology is used to demonstrate some understanding. Final mark for descriptor: 3	

		Understanding-Concepts: Markband 1-2 Some concepts are identified with partial effectiveness. There is a lack of depth of understanding due to the vagueness of most explanations and some repetition. Final mark for the descriptor: 2
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**3**	Analysis: Markband 3-4 Throughout the EE, there is some evidence of analytical thinking leading to a few relevant findings but not consistently. Final mark for the descriptor: 3 Line of argument: Markband 3-4 A partially consistent line of argument links findings, analysis, evaluation, and conclusions throughout the EE. There is some discontinuity and accumulation of information in some paragraphs which does not allow for the higher level of achievement in the line of argument. Final mark for the descriptor: 3
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**3**	Discussion: Markband 3-4 The discussion is partly balanced, but not all findings are supported by evidence. Few are analytical and most are descriptive and supported by evidence. Final mark for the descriptor: 3 Evaluation: Markband 3-4 There is a superficial evaluation of the effectiveness of the EE, but some limitations are mentioned at the beginning and throughout the EE, with a lack of explanation and evaluation of consequences. Final mark for the descriptor: 3
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**1**	Evaluative: Markband 1 Reflection on the EE learning experience is clearly descriptive. Final mark for the descriptor: 1 Growth: Markband 1 The reflection shows little or no evidence of the student's growth and application of transfer skills. Final mark for the descriptor: 1 **Only the first 500 words have been marked.

Total marks awarded	11/30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	Overall, the student has shown a foundational understanding of the topic and demonstrated potential in several areas. By refining the focus of the research question, improving the consistency and application of research methods, and providing more detailed explanations of key concepts, the student can enhance the clarity and depth of the essay. Ensuring a coherent and continuous line of argument will improve the analytical rigor, while supporting findings with robust evidence and offering a thorough evaluation of the research process will add depth to the discussion. Additionally, developing a more evaluative and introspective approach to reflection will better demonstrate the student's growth and application of skills. With these targeted improvements, the student can significantly elevate the quality of their extended essay. The performance, with a total of 11 out of 30 marks, indicates poor performance in the development of the extended essay.	